

Unit 4 is a written paper, testing the other three skills, with a variety of tasks involving comprehension and manipulation of language as well as an extended essay. It represents 35% of the marks for A Level.

For full information about the units, see Appendix B.

1.3 Qualification Titles and Levels

These qualifications are shown on a certificate as:

- OCR Advanced Subsidiary GCE in French, German or Spanish.
- OCR Advanced GCE in French, German or Spanish

Both qualifications are Level 3 in the National Qualification Framework (NQF).

1.4 Aims

The aims of these specifications are to encourage students to:

- develop an interest in, and an enthusiasm for, language learning;
- develop understanding of the language in a variety of contexts and genres;
- communicate confidently, clearly and effectively in the language for a range of purposes;
- develop awareness and understanding of the contemporary society, cultural background and heritage of countries or communities where the language is spoken;
- consider their study of the language in a broader context.

The specification also aims to:

and in addition, at A Level, to:

- provide a sufficient basis for the further study of languages at degree level or equivalent.

1.5 Prior Learning/Attainment

It is recommended that students beginning to study French/German/Spanish at AS and A Level should have the knowledge, understanding and skills equivalent to those for GCSE at Higher tier in the language.

2.1 AS Units

Unit 1: *Speaking* (French F701/German F711/Spanish F721)

Unit 2: *Listening, Reading and Writing 1* (French F702/German F712/Spanish F722)

2.1.1 Knowledge, Understanding and Skills

AS candidates will be required to:

- listen and respond to a variety of spoken sources, including authentic sources;
- read and respond to a variety of written texts, including authentic sources, covering different contexts, registers, styles and genres;
- adapt their spoken and written language appropriately for different situations and purposes;
- use the language accurately to express facts and ideas and to present explanations, opinions and information in both speech and writing;
- transfer meaning from English, Welsh or Irish into the modern foreign language;
- understand and apply the grammatical system and a range of structures as detailed in the AS specification;
- study materials that illustrate aspects of the contemporary society, cultural background and heritage of one or more of the countries or communities where the language is spoken.

2.1.2 Language Topic Areas

Spoken and written sources will include material that relates to the contemporary society, cultural background and heritage of one or more of the countries or communities where the language is spoken. The topic areas for the AS specifications are:

Aspects of daily life sub-topics

- The family: different structures and relationships; living conditions (housing, shopping and patterns of daily life)
- Food, drink, health, obsessions and addictions

Leisure and entertainment sub-topics

- Sport (including national sporting concerns and traditions)
- Tourism and related themes: tourism as a changing phenomenon; tourism and the environment
- Leisure activities: aspects of cultural life, e.g. film, theatre; the arts as part of leisure time.

Communication and media sub-topics

- Communication technology: patterns and changes to communication in daily life
- Media, e.g. written press; radio; television (roles and influences).

Education and training sub-topics

- School and school life: individual experiences; local and national concerns
- Work and training: individual experiences; school to work preparation, transition and aspirations.

2.1.3 Grammar

The grammatical content for study at AS has been agreed at a national level between QCA, all awarding bodies and professional teacher associations.

For full details, see Appendix C2.

2.2.1 Knowledge, Understanding and Skills

In addition to the requirements for the AS units, A Level candidates will be required to:

- use the language to present viewpoints, develop arguments, analyse and evaluate in speech and writing;
- transfer meaning from the modern foreign language into English, Welsh or Irish;
- understand and apply the grammatical system and a range of structures as detailed in the A Level specification;
- study aspects of the contemporary society, cultural background and heritage of one or more of the countries or communities whose language is being studied.

2.2.2 Language Topic Areas

Spoken and written sources will include material that relates to the contemporary society, cultural background and heritage of one or more of the countries or communities where the language is spoken. The topic areas for the A2 specification are:

Society sub-topics

- Integration and exclusion: age; gender; race; religion; equality of opportunity
- Law and order: trends of crime and punishment; civil unrest; policing
- Unemployment: causes and consequences (local, national or global).

The environment sub-topics

- The individual and the environment: recycling; reducing individual energy usage and impact; local conservation
- Energy management: alternative energy sources; changing use of fossil fuels; nuclear energy; changing energy demands

Science and technology: impact and issues sub-topics

- Medical progress: development and change – impacts on health care, lifestyles, ethics and beliefs
- Scientific advances: change and innovation – impacts and issues on society, knowledge, education
- Technological developments: change and development – impacts on lifestyles, habits, work and education.

Culture sub-topics

- Literature and the arts: trends, changes, influences and impacts on individuals and society
- Political issues: changes at local and national level; impacts on the individual and society
- Heritage and history: influence and impacts of heritage (including colonial heritage) and historical events (national and international) on contemporary society.

2.2.3 Grammar

The grammatical content for study at A Level has been agreed at a national level between QCA, all awarding bodies and professional teacher associations.

For full details, see Appendix C2.

3.1 AS Unit 1: *Speaking*

(French F701/German F711/Spanish F721)

The tasks are based on topics listed in the AS topic areas.

Section A: Role-play

Using French, German or Spanish, candidates should be able to:

- explain the English stimulus material;
- understand and respond to the examiner.

Section B: Topic discussion

Using French, German or Spanish, candidates should be able to:

- discuss a topic in detail, explaining facts and ideas and justifying points of view.
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3.2 AS Unit 2: *Listening, Reading and Writing 1*

(French F702/German F712/Spanish F722)

Section A: Listening and writing

Candidates should be able to:

- understand the stimulus material;
- respond to tasks that do not involve productive use of French, German or Spanish;
- respond in English;
- respond by transferring meaning from English into French, German or Spanish.

Section B: Reading and writing

Candidates should be able to:

- understand the stimulus material;
 - respond to tasks that do not involve productive use of French, German or Spanish;
 - respond in writing to tasks in French, German or Spanish – short answer format;
 - respond in writing to tasks in French, German or Spanish – extended answer format.
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3.3 A2 Unit 3: *Speaking* (French F703/German F713/Spanish F723)

The task in Section A is based on topics listed in the AS and A2 topic areas.

The task in Section B is based on topics listed in the A2 topic areas.

Section A: Discussion of article

Using French, German or Spanish, candidates should be able to:

- understand and respond to the French, German or Spanish stimulus article;
- understand and respond to the examiner;
- discuss ideas presented in the stimulus article.

Section B: Topic discussion

Using French, German or Spanish, candidates should be able to:

- discuss one or two sub-topics from either the same or different A2 topic areas, presenting and analysing the ideas, developing and justifying points of view.
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3.4 A2 Unit 4: *Listening, Reading and Writing 2* (French F704/German F714/Spanish F724)

Section A: Listening and writing

Candidates should be able to:

- understand the stimulus material;
- respond in writing to tasks in French, German or Spanish and in English.

Section B: Reading and writing

Candidates should be able to:

- understand the stimulus material;
- respond to tasks that do not involve productive use of French, German or Spanish;
- respond to tasks that require productive writing in French, German or Spanish and in English.

Section C: Writing

Candidates should be able to:

- write an essay in French, German or Spanish, presenting, developing and evaluating information, ideas and arguments on a topic related to one of the A2 topic areas.
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4.1 AS GCE Scheme of Assessment

For full details of the marking grids for the assessment criteria at AS and A Level, see Appendix D.

AS GCE Modern Foreign Languages (French H075/German H076/Spanish H077)

AS Unit 1: *Speaking* (French F701/German F711/Spanish F721)

30% of the total AS GCE marks This test has **two** sections:

15 min speaking test
